5 Free Certificates to Break Into Finance in the Age of AI

Five free certificates that prove you can use AI on real finance work, from AI fundamentals to building a financial chatbot and running quant models. Counted from one to five.

1. AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations

by Anthropic (Anthropic Academy)

WHAT IT IS
Anthropic's own course on working with AI: how to prompt well, how to evaluate what AI gives you, and where it goes wrong. It ends with a final assessment and a certificate of completion.

WHY IT MATTERS
Banks want analysts who can use AI without blindly trusting it. This one comes straight from the company that builds Claude.

TIME & COST
Free

WHERE TO GET IT
https://anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-framework-foundations

2. GenAI Job Simulation

by Boston Consulting Group (BCG) on Forage

WHAT IT IS
You're a junior data scientist on BCG's GenAI team. You pull key numbers from real company 10-K and 10-Q filings, then build an AI chatbot that answers financial questions.

WHY IT MATTERS
You walk into interviews having built a financial AI tool on real filings, which is a far better story than "I've used ChatGPT."

TIME & COST
Free, about 3 to 4 hours

WHERE TO GET IT
https://www.theforage.com/simulations/bcg/gen-ai-anlo

3. AI in Action

by Vista Equity Partners on Forage

WHAT IT IS
You're a Business Operations Associate on Vista's Portfolio Operations team. You learn Vista's prompt engineering method, turn messy multi-source data into decision-ready insights, and design repeatable AI workflows.

WHY IT MATTERS
Vista has gone all-in on generative AI across its portfolio, and this puts a private equity name on your resume in an afternoon.

TIME & COST
Free, about 1 to 2 hours

WHERE TO GET IT
https://www.theforage.com/simulations/vista-equity-partners/ai-in-action-cugo

4. Quantitative Research Job Simulation

by J.P. Morgan on Forage

WHAT IT IS
You work like a J.P. Morgan quant, using Python, data analysis and machine learning on problems like commodity pricing and credit risk.

WHY IT MATTERS
These are the data and modeling skills behind AI in trading and risk. It's the hardest one on this list, which is exactly why it stands out.

TIME & COST
Free, about 6 to 7 hours

WHERE TO GET IT
https://www.theforage.com/simulations/jpmorgan/quantitative-research-11oc

5. ChatGPT for Finance

by Simplilearn (SkillUp)

WHAT IT IS
A beginner course on using AI for everyday finance work: financial analysis, market research, investment decisions and automating busy work.

WHY IT MATTERS
It's the fastest way to show you already know how to use AI on the tasks analysts do every day.

TIME & COST
Free, with a certificate on completion

WHERE TO GET IT
https://www.simplilearn.com/chatgpt-for-finance-course-skillup

RESUME TIP: List these under **Certifications**, not work experience. Forage simulations aren't internships, and BCG specifically asks that you don't list its simulation as work experience.

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